How a deal becomes final

Draft agreements, versions, holds, approvals, and the stop rules.

> **AFTER THIS LESSON**
> You can explain exactly when a deal becomes a commitment, and what happens when it doesn't.

One draft agreement per batch

Each surplus batch gets one shared, numbered draft agreement. It records how much of each item goes to which food bank, who moves it and when, and what storage it needs. Agents edit it in turns, and every edit carries a reason.

Versions

Every change creates a new version, and **approvals for an old version don't carry over**. This stops a classic failure: a manager approves "200 lb by 4 pm," the plan quietly changes to "200 lb by 8 pm," and the old approval still counts.

Holds

Each organization places a hold on its own resource, such as cold storage space, a truck slot, a drop-off slot, or the batch itself. A hold is tied to one version and expires. Only the resource's owner can place it, so two deals can't book the same cooler space.

Approvals

Each organization's own person approves the exact version through n8n. n8n just carries the decision; it never decides.

Commitment

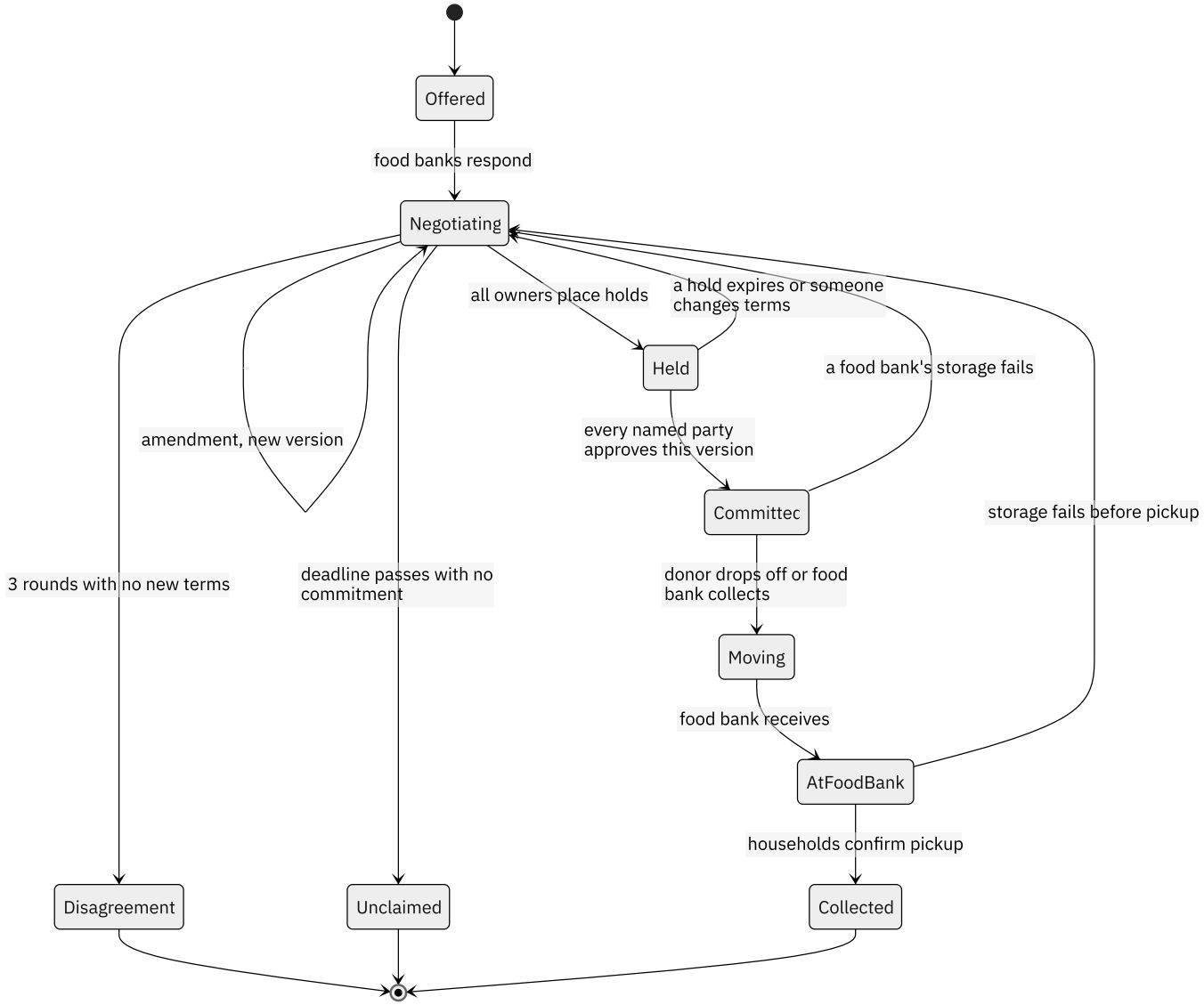
A deal is final when **every named organization has approved the same version** and **every**

hold is still valid.

The stop rules

- **Agreement:** the deal becomes a commitment, as above.
- **Ask a human:** any doubt about the produce's condition, or any change to a deal that's already committed.
- **Keep the disagreement:** after three rounds with no new terms, the dashboards of the organizations involved show each option and each side's reason.
- **Deadline:** if the donor's deadline passes with no commitment, the produce is recorded as unclaimed, with a reason. **Nothing is ever committed automatically.**

After a commitment, the batch moves through four stages: *Moving* (the donor drops it off or the food bank collects it), *At food bank*, *Collected* (households confirm pickup), or back to *Negotiating* if a food bank's storage fails.



The life of a draft agreement, from offer to collected, disagreement, or unclaimed. From docs/MVP_DESIGN.md.

Source: docs/MVP_DESIGN.md, section 8, the lifecycle diagram, and ADR 0001.

Read next: docs/MVP_DESIGN.md, section 8, including the lifecycle diagram.

Previous: Lesson 5: Produce profiles and matching · **Next:** Lesson 7: The five workflows

Quick lookup: HarvestNet at a glance.

Anything unclear? Ask me. I'm your teacher for this, and I can re-explain any part in different words.

Source of truth: docs/MVP_DESIGN.md, CONTEXT.md, and docs/adr/. If this lesson and those disagree, they win.